Establishing a new data archive

Marijana Glavica <mglavica@ffzg.hr>

CROSSDA - Croatian Social Science Data Archive
University of Zagreb Faculty of Humanities and Social Sciences

European DDI Users Conference
An Introduction to DDI for Small Organisations
1 December 2025

CC BY

CROSSDA

Croatian Social Science Data Archive

- Serves as a national public research infrastructure for the social sciences research data
- Croatian Service provider for **CESSDA ERIC**
  - Ministry of Science, Education and Sports - national representative in GA
  - University of Zagreb Faculty of Humanities and Social Sciences - hosting institution / national coordinating institution

https://crossda.hr

REPUBLIC OF CROATIA
Ministry of Science, Education and Youth

Sveučilište u Zagrebu
Filozofski fakultet
University of Zagreb
Faculty of Humanities and Social Sciences

CROSSDA beginnings

A roller coaster ride

- The first initiative in 2006 !!
- First project towards establishing a data archive in 2012; Development and establishment plans created and revised during the next two projects
- Several years of uncertainty and doubts
- Established in 2020, after Croatia became a member of CESSDA in late 2019

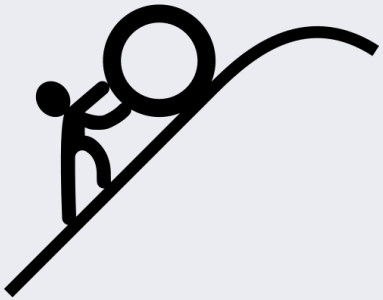
SERSCIDA
2012-2014
EC, FP7
ADP, FORS, UKDA, SND, Bosnia and Herzegovina, Croatia, Serbia

seeds
2015-2017
SNSF, SCOPES
FORS, ADP, Albania, Croatia, Kosovo, Montenegro, Serbia

cessda saw
2015-2017
EC, H2020
CESSDA SPs and partners

Challenging environment

- Lack of data sharing culture
- Lack of incentives for data sharing for researchers
- Lack of staff
- Limited budget

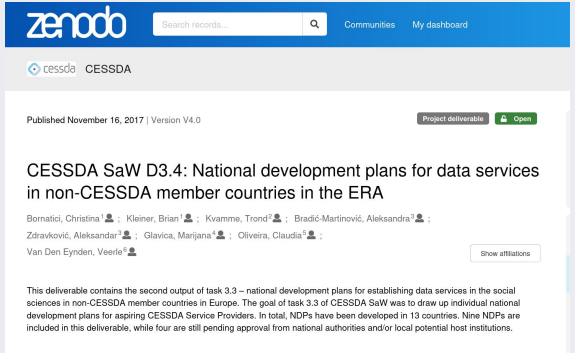


challenge by Lucas Helle from Noun Project (CCBY3.0)

Development and establishment plans

- Definition of organisation
- Mission
- Scope of collection
- Services and activities
- Beneficiaries
- Governance structure
- Financing schemes

- Technical infrastructure
- Policies, quality control procedures, and workflows



Scope of collection

- **Social sciences research data**
  (sociology, psychology, education science, information science, political science, and economics)
  - Quantitative data (surveys, experiments)
  - Qualitative data (interviews, focus groups)
  - Contemporary and historical data
  - Traditional-scale data (not big data)

Services

CORE SERVICES

- **Curation for long-term preservation of data**
- Maintaining a catalogue of archived data
- Enabling access to data, access rights administration
- Support, assistance, and advice for data depositors and data users
- Data management and planning support and training for social science researchers and students

ADDITIONAL SERVICES AND ACTIVITIES

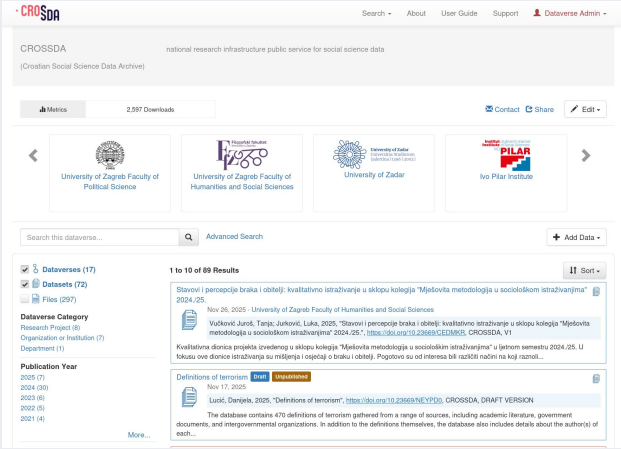
- Providing training on using software for statistical analysis, data management and anonymisation
- Organising statistical courses
- Advocating for transparency and openness of research

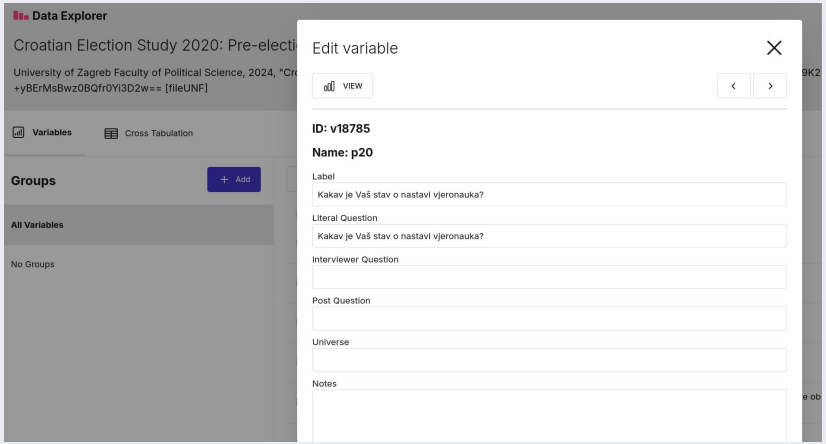
Domain specific / disciplinary repository

- Support discipline-specific reuse
- Use discipline-specific metadata schemas and vocabularies
- Require rich, structured metadata (study design, instruments, variables, etc.)
- Provide subject-matter curation
  - Review for data quality, documentation completeness, ethical/legal compliance
  - Discipline-specific anonymisation or disclosure-control
- Policies tailored to discipline norms (e.g. different access levels based on disclosure risk)

Tools for DDI

- Focus on open source and low-cost solutions
- Tested: Nesstar, EPrints
- Implemented: **Dataverse** with **Data Explorer**





Metadata creation and review process

- Study metadata
  - Depositor enters metadata directly into Dataverse
  - Curator reviews and corrects metadata
  - Depositor approves corrections
- Variable metadata
  - Ingested during tabular data ingest (SPSS, Stata)
  - Enhanced by data curator who enter literal questions
- Metadata review currently done in a shared document (Google Docs)

ELSST Thesaurus

cessda VS Vocabulary Service

Metadata exchange

- Inclusion of CROSSDA metadata into the CESSDA Data Catalogue (CDC)
- Work on CESSDA Question Bank in progress

cessda
MV Metadata Validator

CESSDA Data Catalogue

Thank you for your attention!

data.archive@ffzg.hr
crossda.hr